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Surveillance camera

from one location, while cameras are normally used for long-range coverage and night-vision facility. Further, commercial installations normally use high-quality coaxial cable. In home segment, pre-made CCTV cables (with BNC and RCA adaptors) that are cheaper and thinner are preferred.

Manufacturing scenario in India

At present, the Indian electronic security industry is largely import based with a handful of indigenous manufacturers struggling to survive in a market full of giant global players and an unorganised open market. The imported CCTV cameras are usually cheaper than those made in India.

However, initiatives are being taken to encourage indigenous manufacturing, as there is increasing demand for electronic security solutions and the need of customisation. Local manufacturers are playing a major role to cater to the requirements of

Indian customers. Seeing the opportunity, many new companies are joining the fray. Matrix, an access control and time-attendance solutions provider, is one such company which is soon going to launch DVRs and cameras.

The local manufacturing will get a boost with government support.

"Indian manufacturers should get preferences in government purchase if they fulfil the requirements. Further, the additional burden of excise duty in the budget should be withdrawn, in order to make locally manufactured products more price-competitive in the market," says Ray.

The market is flooded with cheap, low-end products from China. The government should work on standardisation of electronic security equipment and come out with standardisation/quality policy to protect the Indian buyers' interests and investment. ●

The author is executive editor for EFY magazine